The passing-out parade on 7 June 1980 was attended by my parents, and this time, my father took pictures of the correct person. I had wanted Veena to come for the parade, especially since her father was posted at Dehradun, but they had gone to Pune for the summer holidays, so I would meet her there anyway. Along with my CMs, I walked past in slow march to the strains of 'Auld Lang Syne' into the portals of Chetwode Hall, over the plaque that says '*Antim Pag*' (Final Step), marking the culmination of one's training. The pipping ceremony that followed was equally emotional. We took a solemn oath '. . . *to bear true faith and allegiance to the Constitution of India as by the law established and . . . go wherever ordered by land, sea or air, . . . even to the peril of [my] life*.' Col Mayne, a SIKH LI officer, came up to my mother, and congratulating her, said that from that day onwards, I was theirs, i.e. the Regiment's, which brought fresh tears to her eyes, as she had not much liked the '*even to the peril of my life*' part of the oath. I was now IC 38750H 2/Lieutenant MM Naravane. The transition from civvies to uniform was complete.

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